information. As a result, relatives of those Americans living in Israel-occupied Palestine could become targets.

Snowden was also astonished when he discovered a memo showing the NSA was spying on US political radicals, specifically their habits of viewing online pornography. The memo—written by NSA Director Keith Alexander—suggested the information could be used to destroy the reputations of people critical of the US government. The memo included the names of six individuals who could be targeted.

Snowden believed US intelligence had too much power and too little public oversight. He became increasingly compelled to make the American public aware of what he considered were illegal government activities.

QUIET GEEK

After Snowden was revealed as the man behind the NSA leaks, journalists interviewed people who knew him. Joyce Kinsey, a Maryland neighbor of the Snowden family, said, "He was a quiet guy, kept to himself. He always dressed nice, was clean cut. He just reminded me of a brainiac. I feel terrible for his family." Dr. Angel Cunanan, a neighbor of Snowden and his girlfriend in Hawaii, told a reporter, "They['d] just say, 'Hi' and 'Hello' in the morning. He mentioned that he worked for the government. . . . There was nothing strange, nothing like that."[6] An anonymous friend said, "He was a geek like the rest of us. We played video games, watched anime. It was before geek was cool."[7]

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